# Metta Sutta

I. The Practitioner and the Purpose of the Practice
   1. The practitioner: one who is skilled in the good (*karaṇīyam atthakusalena*)
   2. The purpose: to realize that state of peace (*yan taṃ santaṃ padaṃ abhisamecca*)

II. Prerequisites to the Practice of Mettā (Fifteen Qualities)
   1. *Sakko*: able, capable, in the spiritual life
   2. *Ujū*: upright (not deceptive, not crooked)
   3. *Sūjū*: honest (not hypocritical, not pretending to have virtues one doesn't possess)
   4. *Suvaco*: easy to speak to, amenable to correction
   5. *Mudu*: gentle, soft
   6. *Anatimānī*: not arrogant, not proud
   7. *Santussako*: contented
   8. *Subharo*: easy to support
   9. *Appakicco*: not involved with many duties
   10. *Sallahukavuttī*: light in one's activities
   11. *Santindriyo*: with calm sense faculties
   12. *Nipako*: discreet, possessing pragmatic wisdom
   13. *Appagabbho*: not impudent
   14. *Kulesu ananugiddho*: not greedy when among families
   15. *Na ca khuddaṃ samācare kiñci yena viññū pare upavadeyyuṃ*: and he should not do anything even slight because of which other wise ones might reproach him.

   (Note: Items 1-14 are morality as positive conduct (*cāritta-sīla*); item 15 is morality as restraint (*vāritta-sīla*))

III. The Meditative Development of Mettā
   1. General statement: "May all beings be well (well in body, physical health); safe and secure (free from harm and danger). May all beings be happy!" (*sukhino vā khemino hontu, sabbe sattā bhavantu sukhitattā*)
   2. The classes of beings (*ye keci pāṇā bhūt'atthi*): dyads and triads
      (a) the frail and the strong (*tasā vā thāvarā vā anavasesā*)
      (b) long, middling, short (*dīghā majjhimā rassakā*)
      (c) large, middling, small (*mahantā majjhimā aṇukā*)
      (d) gross, middling, subtle (*thūlā majjhimā aṇukā*)
      (e) the seen and unseen (*diṭṭhā vā ye vā adiṭṭhā*)
      (f) those dwelling far, those dwelling near (*ye ca dure vasanti avidure*)
      (g) those that have come to be and those about to come to be (*bhūta vā sambhavesī vā*)
   3. Repeat generalization: "May all beings be happy (*sabbe sattā bhavantu sukhitattā*)!"

4. Mettā as the wish for peace and harmony among beings: "Let there be no deceit, contempt, or ill will between beings!" (*na paro paraṃ nikubbetha n'ātimaññetha katthacinaṃ kañci, byārosanā paṭighasaññā nāññam aññassa dukkham iccheyya*)

IV. The Intensification and Expansion of Mettā

1. Intensification of mettā: "As a mother would, with all her life, protect her only child (*mātā yathā niyaṃ puttaṃ āyusā ekaputtaṃ anurakkhe*), so one should develop a measureless mind towards all beings (*evam pi sabbabhūtesu mānasaṃ bhāvaye aparimāṇaṃ*)."
2. Expansion: "Develop a measureless mind of mettā to all the world" (*mettañ ca sabbalokasmiṃ mānasaṃ bhāvaye aparimāṇaṃ*) – "above, below, and across, unconfined, without enmity, without hostility" (*uddhaṃ adho ca tiriyaṃ ca, asambādhaṃ averaṃ asapattaṃ*)
3. "As long as one isn't asleep, maintain the mindfulness of mettā in all postures (*tiṭṭhaṃ caraṃ nisinno vā sayāno vā yāva tassa vigatamiddho, etaṃ satim adhiṭṭheyya*); this, they say, is the abode of brahmā here (*brahmam etaṃ vihāraṃ idha-m-āhu*)."

V. Turning Mettā towards Wisdom

1. Not approaching views (*diṭṭhiṃ ca anupagamma*)
2. Virtuous (*sīlavā*)
3. Endowed with vision (*dassanena sampanno*): (= three of the stream-enterer's qualities)
4. Abandoning greed for sensual pleasures (*kāmesu vineyya gedhaṃ*)
5. One does not take rebirth in a womb (*na hi jātu gabbhaseyyaṃ punar eti*): (= attaining the stage of a non-returner)

08 January 2005

# The Ground Plan of the Mangala Sutta with its Thirty-Eight Blessings

**Verse**

**v. 1**. The opening inquiry: What is truly auspicious, truly a blessing?

**v. 2**. *Orientation*: cultivating the conditions for discretion

(1) Not to associate with the foolish (*asevanā bālānaṃ*)

(2) To associate with the wise (*paṇḍitīnaṃ sevanā*)

(3) To venerate those worthy of veneration (*pūjā pūjaniyānaṃ*)

**v. 3**. *Establishing secure foundations*: the inner and outer requisites for success in life

(4) Dwelling in a suitable locality (*paṭirūpadesavāsa*)

(5) Merits done in the past (*pubbe katapuññatā*)

(6) To set oneself on the right course (right resolution: *attasammāpaṇidhi*)

**v. 4**. *Preparations*: training oneself for success in life

(7) A well-rounded education (abundant learning: *bāhusacca*)

(8) Learning a craft or profession (*sippa*)

(9) A code of discipline that has been well trained in (*vinaya susikkhita*)

(10) Well-spoken speech (*subhāsitā vācā*)

**vv. 5, 6**: *Leading a virtuous life in the world*:

**v.5**. *Fulfilling family responsibilities*

(11) Supporting one's mother and father (*mātāpitu-upaṭṭhāna*)

(12) Maintaining a wife (husband) and children (*puttadārasaṅgahaṃ*

(13) A harmless occupation (*anākulā kammantā*)

**v.6.** *Becoming a pillar of society*

(14) Generosity (*dāna*)

(15) Dutiful conduct (righteous conduct: *dhammacariyā*)

(16) Helping of relatives and friends (*ñātakānaṃ saṅgaha*}

(17) Blameless actions (*anavajjāni kammāni*)

**v.7.** *Personal ethics*: A life of moral integrity

(18) Ceasing from evil (*ārati pāpā*)

(19) Abstaining from evil (*virati pāpā*)

(20) Abstention from intoxicating drinks (*majjapānā saṃyama*)

(21) Diligence in wholesome practices (*appamādo dhammesu*)

**vv.8, 9.** *Developing a spiritual life*: Cultivating inner virtues

(22) Reverence (*gārava*)

(23) Humility (*nivāta*)

(24) Contentment (*santuṭṭhi*)

(25) Gratitude (*kataññutā*)

(26) Timely hearing of the Dhamma (*kālena dhammassavana*)

(27) Patience (*khanti*)

(28) Being amenable to advice (*sovacassatā*)

(29) Seeing renunciants (*samaṇānaṃ dassanaṃ*)

(30) Timely discussions on the Dhamma (*kālena dhammasākacchā*)

**v.10.** *The ascent towards realization*: practicing and attaining the world-transcending Dhamma

(31) Austerity (*tapa*)
(32) Celibacy (the holy life: *brahmacariya*)
(33) Seeing the Noble Truths (*ariyasaccānadassana*)
(34) Realization of Nirvana (*nibbānasacchikiriyā*)

**v.11.** *Fulfillment*: Embodying the world-transcending Dhamma in the world

(35) A mind unshaken by changing worldly conditions (*phuṭṭhassa lokadhammehi cittaṃ yassa na kampati*)
(36) A mind that is sorrowless (*asokaṃ*)
(37) A mind that is passionless, "dust-free" (*virajaṃ*)
(38) A mind that is secure (*khemaṃ*)

**v.12.** *Conclusion*: These are victorious everywhere; they attain security everywhere (*sabbattha-m-apārājitā, sabbattha sotthiṃ gacchanti*).

# Introduction to the Sutta Nipāta

I. The structure of the Sutta Piṭaka: the five Nikāyas or Āgamas
II. The Khuddaka Nikāya, "The Minor (or Miscellaneous) Collection"
III. The Sutta Nipāta
    1. Meaning: *sutta* = discourse; *nipāta* = collection, group, assemblage
    2. Origins of this collection
    3. Contents and prominent themes
IV. The "three suttas": the Ratana, the Mahāmaṅgala, and Karaṇīyametta

## The Ratana Sutta
## The Jewels Discourse

Background story: a triple disaster strikes Vesālī
*Verse 1: Invocation to the spirits*
    1. Speaker: the Buddha (through Venerable Ananda)
    2. The audience: the spirits (bhūtas)
    3. To ward off danger, bestow safety and blessings
    4. Means: Determinations of Truth based on the Three Jewels
*Verse 2: Instructions to the spirits*
    1. Mutual help between human beings and spirits
    2. The sharing of merit with the devas and spirits
*Verse 3: The Buddha as the Peerless Jewel*
    1. The meaning of "Tathāgata"
        A. Nikāyas (Anguttara Nikāya 4:23)
            (1) He has fully awakened to the nature of the world, its origin, cessation, and way to its cessation.
            (2) He has fully awakened to all knowable phenomena.
            (3) All that he speaks is just so (*tathā*).
            (4) He acts in accordance with (*tathā*) his words.
            (5) He is supreme in all the world.
        B. Commentaries (e.g., Dīgha Nikāya Aṭṭhakathā)
            (1) He has "Thus Come" (*tathā āgata*), by fulfilling the Ten Pāramis
            (2) He has "Thus Gone" (*tathā gata*), by perfecting the aids to enlightenment
    2. The Tathāgata as the best of beings (Anguttara 4:34)
    3. The meaning of jewel (*ratana*): whatever is rare, precious, difficult to see, gives delight, is cherished, and fulfills wishes.
    4. Making a Determination of Truth (*saccavacana, saccavajja, saccādhiṭṭhāna*)

*Verse 4: Nibbāna as the Dhamma-Jewel*

1. Meaning of terms
   - destruction (*khayaṃ*): of greed, hatred, and delusion; of craving
   - dispassion (*virāgaṃ*): the "fading away" of passion
   - deathless (*amataṃ*): freedom from birth, aging, and death
   - excellent (*paṇītaṃ*): supreme and of inexhaustible goodness
2. Discovered by the Buddha (*sakyamuni*: "the sage of the Sakyans") in a state of concentration
3. Nibbāna as the supreme dhamma (Anguttara 4:34): "To whatever extent there are things whether conditioned or unconditioned, dispassion is declared the best among them, that is, … the destruction of craving, dispassion, cessation, Nibbaana."

*Verse 5: The Concentration of the Path as the Dhamma-Jewel*

[Revise translation to read:]

5. The supreme Buddha praised that purity, which they call "the concentration with immediate results" (*samādhim ānantariyakam*). There exists no equal to that concentration. This precious jewel is in the Dhamma. By this truth may there be safety.
   1. The Noble Eightfold Path as the best of conditioned dhammas, the best of paths (Anguttara 4:34; Dhammapada 273)
   2. The concentration of the world-transcending path
   3. Why it is praised as supreme above all other concentrations (*not* above all other things!) (*samādhinā tena samo na vijjati*)

*Verse 6: The Eight Noble Persons as the Sangha-Jewel*

1. Who are the "eight individuals praised by the good" (*puggalā aṭṭha sataṃ pasaṭṭhā*)?
2. How they form four pairs (*cattāri etāni yugāni honti*)
3. The worthy disciples of the Fortunate One (*dakkhiṇeyyā sugatassa sāvakā*)
4. Offerings and their fruits (the metaphor of sowing)

*Verse 7: The Arahants as the Sangha-Jewel*

[Revise translation to read:]

7. Those who exerted themselves well with steadfast minds in Gotama's teaching, the desireless ones have attained what should be attained. Having plunged into the Deathless, they enjoy the Peace obtained without price. This precious jewel … (etc.)

1. The importance of effort
2. What should be attained, achieved, and realized
3. The peace without price : the meditative attainment of Nibbana

*Verse 8: The Stream-Enterer as Representing the Sangha-Jewel*

[Revise translation to read:]

8. Just as a city pillar (*indakhila*) fixed in the earth is not shaken by the winds from the four directions, even so, I declare, is the good man who by direct experience (*avecca*) sees the (four) noble truths... (etc.)

1. Seeing the Four Noble Truths: the mark of a stream-enterer
2. How the Four Noble Truths are seen by direct experience
    (a) the path of insight-knowledge (*vipassanā-paññā*)
    (b) the world-transcending breakthrough (*dhammābhisamaya*)
3. How a stream-enterer is "not shaken" like a pillar
4. The ball of cotton and the Indra's Pillar (see reverse)

*Verse 9: The Most Sluggish Stream-Enterer Still Represents the Sangha-Jewel*

1. The three classes of stream-enterers
2. The greatness even of the most sluggish stream-enterer
3. Connected Discourses on the Breakthrough (SN chapter 13)
    (see appendix)

*Verse 10: What Happens With the Attainment of Stream-Entry*

1. What is meant by "vision" (= *dassana*; "insight" = *vipassanā*)?
2. The three things that are abandoned
    (1) *sakkāyadiṭṭhi*: "identity view", view of an existing self
    (2) *vicikicchā*: doubt about Buddha, Dhamma, Sangha, training
    (3) *sīlabbatapārāmāsa*: clinging to rules and observances
3. What are the four states of misery (*apāya*)?
4. What are the six "crimes" (or better: "deeds") that a person-attained-to-vision cannot do?

*Verse 11: The Character of a Stream-Enterer*

[Revise middle sentence to read:]

11. ...For it has been said that such an act is impossible for one who has seen the state (*abhabbatā diṭṭhapadassa vuttā*)....

1. A stream-enterer's moral discipline
2. The practice of confession: "What is the character of those who possesses right view? Although they may commit some kind of offence of a minor type, still they

at once confess it to their spiritual brothers and sisters, and having done that, restrain themselves in the future." (MN 48)

*Verse 12: The Buddha as Teacher of the Dhamma*

[Revise translation to read:]

12. Like a grove of trees with flowering tops in the first heat of summer, just so *he taught* the excellent Dhamma, leading to Nibbāna the supreme good. This precious jewel is in the *Buddha.* By this truth may there be safety.
[N.B. *adesayi* is third person singular aorist, with subject *so*, "he," understood.]

*Verse 13: The Buddha as the Excellent One*

1. Buddha is excellent one because of his qualities; 2."knower of the excellent" because he is knower of Nibbāna; 3. "giver of the excellent" because he gives the gift of the teaching; 4. "bringer of the excellent" because he brings knowledge of the path.

*Verse 14: The Arahants Attain Nibbāna Without Residue*

1. Their "old" karma is destroyed
2. The "new" karma does not produce results
3. The two elements of Nibbāna: with residue and without residue
4. The extinguishing of a lamp

*Verses 15-17: Sakka's verses of praise to the Triple Gem*

(correction translation of 'tathāgata' in these verses)

Appendix

*Samyutta Nikaya 56:39 Indra's Pillar*

"Monks, those ascetics or brahmins who do not understand the Four Noble Truths as they really are—they look up at the face of another ascetic or brahmin, thinking: 'This worthy is surely one who really knows and sees.'

"Suppose, monks, a tuft of cotton wool or kapok, light, wafted by the wind, had settled on an even piece of ground. An easterly wind would drive it westward; a westerly wind would drive it eastward; a northerly wind would drive it southward; a southerly wind would drive it northward. For what reason? Because the tuft is so light. So it is with those ascetics or brahmins who … look up at the face of another ascetic or brahmin, thinking: 'This worthy is surely one who really knows and sees.' For what reason? Because they have not seen the Four Noble Truths.

"But, monks, those ascetics or brahmins who understand the Four Noble Truths as they really are —they do not look up at the face of another ascetic or brahmin, thinking: 'This worthy is surely one who really knows and sees.'

"Suppose, monks, there was an Indra's pillar with a deep base, securely planted, immobile, unshaking. Even if a forceful blast of wind comes—whether from the east, the west, the north, or the south—that pillar would not shake, quake, or tremble. For what reason? Because the pillar has a deep base and is securely planted. So it is with those ascetics or brahmins who … do not look

up at the face of another ascetic or brahmin, thinking: 'This worthy is surely one who really knows and sees.' For what reason? Because, monks, they have clearly seen the Four Noble Truths.

"Therefore, monks, an exertion should be made to understand suffering, its origin, its cessation, and the way to its cessation."

*Samyutta Nikaya 13:1 The Fingernail*

The Blessed One took up a little bit of soil in his fingernail and addressed the monks thus:

"Monks, which is more: the little bit of soil that I took up in my fingernail or this great earth?"

"Venerable sir, the great earth is more. The little bit of soil that the Blessed One took up in his fingernail is trifling. It does not amount to a hundredth part, or a thousandth part, or a hundred thousandth part of the great earth."

"So too, monks, for a noble disciple, a person accomplished in view who has made the breakthrough, the suffering that has been destroyed and eliminated is more, while that which remains is trifling. The latter does not amount to a hundredth part, or a thousandth part, or a hundred thousandth part of the former mass of suffering that has been destroyed and eliminated, as there is a maximum of seven more lives. Of such great benefit, monks, is the breakthrough to the Dhamma, of such great benefit is it to obtain the vision of the Dhamma."

*Samyutta Nikaya 13:11 Sineru the King of Mountains*

"O monks, suppose that a man would place on Sineru, the king of mountains, seven grains of gravel the size of mung beans. What do you think, which is more: the seven grains of gravel the size of mung beans that have been placed there or Sineru, the king of mountains?"

"Venerable sir, Sineru, the king of mountains, is more. The seven grains of gravel the size of mung beans are trifling. They do not amount to a hundredth part, or a thousandth part, or a hundred thousandth part of Sineru, the king of mountains."

"So too, monks, the achievements of ascetics, brahmins, and wanderers of other sects do not amount to a hundredth part, or a thousandth part, or a hundred thousandth part of the achievement of a noble disciple, a person accomplished in view who has made the breakthrough. So great in achievement is a person accomplished in view, so great in direct knowledge."

# 25 *Okkantisamyutta*

## Connected Discourses on Entering

### *1 The Eye*

At Sāvatthī. "Bhikkhus, the eye is impermanent, changing, becoming otherwise. The ear … The nose … The tongue … The body … The mind is impermanent, changing, becoming otherwise. One who places faith in these teachings and resolves on them thus is called a faith-follower, one who has entered the fixed course of rightness, entered the plane of superior persons, transcended the plane of the worldlings. He is incapable of doing any deed by reason of which he might be reborn in hell, in the animal realm, or in the domain of ghosts; he is incapable of passing away without having realized the fruit of stream-entry.[268]

"One for whom these teachings are accepted thus after being pondered to a sufficient degree with wisdom is called a Dhamma-follower,[269] one who has entered the fixed course of rightness, entered the plane of superior persons, transcended the plane of the worldlings. He is incapable of doing any deed by reason of which he might be reborn in hell, in the animal realm, or in the domain of ghosts; he is incapable of passing away without having realized the fruit of stream-entry.

"One who knows and sees these teachings thus is called a stream-enterer, no longer bound to the nether world, fixed in destiny, with enlightenment as his destination."[270]

268 The faith-follower (*saddhānusārī*) and the Dhamma-follower (*dhammānusārī*), described just below, are the two classes of disciples who are practicing for realization of the fruit of stream-entry. The two are the lowest ranking members of a comprehensive sevenfold typology of noble disciples found, with formal definitions, at MN I 477–79. The seven types are also defined, somewhat differently, at Pp 14–15 (§§30–36) and at Vism 659–60 (Ppn 21:74–78). The faith-follower and the Dhamma-follower are also distinguished at **55:24** (V 377,8–24) and **55:25** (V 379,10–21), though the terms themselves are not used there. At **48:12–17** they come at the end of the more usual list of noble persons, in place of the one practising for the realization of the fruit of stream-entry, and here the faith-follower is placed below the Dhamma-follower for the reason that his faculties are weaker.

Briefly, the faith-follower and the Dhamma-follower differ with regard to their dominant faculty: the former relies on faith as the vehicle of progress, the latter on wisdom. When they attain the fruit of stream-entry, the former becomes "one liberated by faith" (*saddhāvimutta*; see MN I 478,29–34), the latter "one attained by view" (*diṭṭhippatta*; see MN I 478,18–23).

According to the Abhidhamma system, with its conception of the supramundane path as lasting for only a single mind-moment, both the faith-follower and the Dhamma-follower should be such for only the one mind-moment of the path. This interpretation, however, though advocated by the commentaries, is difficult to reconcile with the Nikāyas. For an interesting discussion of the two models, see Gethin, *The Buddhist Path to Awakening*, pp. 129–33.

Spk explains "the fixed course of rightness" (*sammattaniyāma*) as the noble path (*ariyamagga*). On the clause, "he is incapable of passing away without having realized the fruit of stream-entry," Spk says that once the path has arisen there can be no obstruction to the fruit. It quotes Pp 13 (§20): "Should this person be one practising for the realization of the fruit of stream-entry, and should it be the time when the aeon is to burn up, the aeon will not burn up until that person realizes the fruit of stream-entry."

269 On the Dhamma-follower, see **n. 268**. The commentaries do not clarify the syntax of the expression *ime dhammā evam paññāya mattaso nijjhānam khamanti*. Though *nijjhānam* is accusative, in English idiom it is more naturally rendered with an ablative sense.

Spk: *Mattaso nijjhānam khamantī ti pamānato olokanam khamanti*; "Accepted after being pondered to a sufficient degree": accepted in measure (through) examination. Spk-p$_{ć}$: *Olokanan ti saccābhisamayasankhātam dassanam; khamanti sahanti, ñāyantī ti attho*; "Examination": vision consisting in the breakthrough to the truths. "Accepted": consented to, meaning "are known."

Spk-pþ is trying to identify the Dhamma-follower's "examination" or "pondering" of the teachings with the breakthrough to the truths achieved on the occasion of stream-entry, but the sutta itself distinguishes them, the former being merely preliminary to the latter.

270 This statement makes it clear how the stream-enterer differs from those on the way to stream-entry. The faith-follower accepts the teachings on trust (with a limited degree of understanding), the Dhamma-follower through investigation; but the stream-enterer has *known and seen* the teachings directly. I read with Se: *evam jānāti evam passati*.

# THE SEVEN FACTORS OF ENLIGHTENMENT

| ENLIGHTENMENT FACTOR | DESCRIPTION IN SUTTAS | PRINCIPAL CONDITION (SUTTAS) | OTHER CONDITIONS (COMMENTARIES) |
|---|---|---|---|
| Mindfulness (*sati*) | "One recollects (*anussarati*) that dhamma & thinks it over" (SN 46:3). "Unmuddled mindfulness is established in him" (SN 54:13). | Giving careful attention to things that are a basis for the enlightenment factor of mindfulness (SN 46:2, 51) | (1) mindfulness and clear comprehension<br>(2) avoiding muddled persons<br>(3) associating with mindful people<br>(4) suitable inclination |
| Investigation of phenomena (*dhammavicaya*) | "He discriminates that dhamma with wisdom, examines it, investigates it" (SN 46:3, 54:13). | Giving careful attention to wholesome and unwholesome states, blameless and faulty states, bright and dark states | (1) inquiring about aggregates, etc.<br>(2) personal cleanliness<br>(3) balancing spiritual faculties<br>(4) deep reflection<br>(5) associating with wise people<br>(6) suitable inclination |
| Energy (*viriya*) | "His energy is aroused without slackening." | Giving careful attention to the three elements of energy: the element of arousal, the element of endeavor, the element of unstoppable advance | (1) reflection on dangers in samsara<br>(2) seeing benefits in energy<br>(3) reflecting on greatness of Dhamma<br>(4) avoiding lazy persons<br>(5) associating with diligent people<br>(6) suitable inclination |
| Rapture (*pīti*) | "Spiritual rapture arises in him." | Giving careful attention to things that are a basis for the enlightenment factor of rapture | (1) recollection of Three Jewels<br>(2) pure moral practice<br>(3) avoiding bad people<br>(4) associating with good people<br>(5) suitable inclination |
| Tranquility (*passaddhi*) | "The body becomes tranquil and the mind becomes tranquil." | Giving careful attention to tranquility of body and tranquility of mind | (1) avoiding restless people<br>(2) associating with calm people<br>(3) suitable inclination |
| Concentration (*samādhi*) | "For one whose body is tranquil and who is happy, the mind is concentrated." | Giving careful attention to the sign of serenity, the sign of non-dispersion | (1) balancing the faculties<br>(2) skill in meditation<br>(3) avoiding restless people<br>(4) associating with concentrated people<br>(5) suitable inclination |
| Equanimity (*upekkhā*) | "He closely looks on with equanimity at the mind thus concentrated." | Giving careful attention to things that are a basis for the enlightenment factor of equanimity | (1) non-attachment<br>(2) avoiding egotistical people<br>(3) associating with impartial people<br>(4) suitable inclination |

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# THE FIVE AGGREGATES (PANCAKKHANDHA)

| AGGREGATE | CHARACTERISTIC (SN 22:79) | CONTENTS (SN 22:56, 57) | CONDITION (SN 22:56,57) | ADDITIONAL CONDITIONS (COMMENTARIES) | SIMILE (SN 22:95) |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| form (*rūpa*) | "It is deformed, by heat, cold, sun, wind, etc." | Four great elements and form derived from them | nutriment | ignorance<br>craving<br>kamma | a lump of foam |
| feeling (*vedanā*) | "It feels: pleasure, pain, neither pain nor pleasure." | 6 classes of feeling: feeling born of contact through eye, ear, nose, tongue, body, and mind | contact | ignorance<br>craving<br>kamma | a water bubble |
| perception (*saññā*) | "It perceives: blue, yellow, red, white." | 6 classes of perception: perception of forms, sounds, odors, tastes, tactiles, and mental phenomena | contact | ignorance<br>craving<br>kamma | a shimmering mirage |
| volitional formations (*saṅkhārā*) | "They give form to the conditioned, thus called volitional formations; they give form to form, to feeling, etc." | 6 classes of volition: volition regarding forms, sounds, odors, tastes, tactile objects, and mental phenomena | contact | ignorance<br>craving<br>kamma | the trunk of a banana tree |
| consciousness (*viññāṇa*) | "They cognize: cognize sour, bitter, sweet, salty, etc." | 6 classes of consciousness: eye-consciousness, ear-, nose-, tongue-, body-, and mind-consciousness | name-and-form | ignorance<br>craving<br>kamma | a magical illusion |

# THE FIVE HINDRANCES AND THEIR ELIMINATION

| HINDRANCE | PRIMARY CONDITION | PRIMARY ANTIDOTE | OTHER REMEDIES | HOW ERADICATED | SIMILES |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| Source of information | Saṃyutta 46:51 | Saṃyutta 46:51 | Satipaṭṭhāna Commentary, etc. | Satipaṭṭhāna Commentary, etc. | Saṃyutta 46:55<br>Dīgha 2; Majjhima 39 |
| Sensual desire (*kāmacchanda*) | Careless attention to an attractive object (*subha-nimitta*) | Careful attention to an unattractive object (*asubha-nimitta*) | • Guarding senses<br>• Moderation in food<br>• Good friends, suitable conversation | Path of arahantship (based on premise that here 'sensual desire' represents all craving) | • Water mixed with paints<br>• Being in debt |
| Ill will (*byāpāda*) | Careless attention to a repugnant object (*paṭigha-nimitta*) | Careful attention to the liberation of the mind through loving-kindness | • Guarding senses<br>• Moderation in food<br>• Good friends, suitable conversation | Path of non-returner | • Boiling water<br>• Severe illness |
| Dullness and drowiness (*thīnamiddha*) | Careless attention to discontent, lethargy, torpor after meals, sluggishness of mind | Careful attention to the three elements of energy: aroused effort, persistent effort, vigorous effort | • Moderation in food<br>• Changing postures<br>• Perception of light<br>• Living in open air<br>• Good friends, suitable conversation | Path of arahantship | • Water overgrown by moss and algae<br>• Imprisonment |
| Restlessness and remorse (*uddhacca-kukkucca*) | Careless attention to the unsettled mind | Careful attention to peace of mind | • Much learning<br>• Asking questions<br>• Skill in Vinaya<br>• Meeting elder monks<br>• Good friends, suitable conversation | *Restlessness*: path of arahantship<br>*Remorse*: path of non-returner | • Water stirred into wavelets by wind<br>• Slavery |
| Doubt (*vicikicchā*) | Careless attention to things that are a basis for doubt | Careful attention to contrasting mental qualities (wholesome and unwholesome, etc.) | • Much learning<br>• Asking questions<br>• Skill in Vinaya<br>• Resolve<br>• Good friends, suitable conversation | Path of stream-entry | Traveling across a barren desert |

# Culakammavibhanga Sutta
## (Majjhima Nikaya No. 135)

I. General statement of "law of karma"

"Beings are (1) the owners of their actions; (2) the heirs of their actions; (3) their actions are their origin (*yoni* = womb), (4) their kinsman, (5) their refuge. (6) Their actions divide beings into the inferior and superior."

II. Four types of karma (according to Majjhima Commentary)

1. *Oppressive karma* (*upapilaka-kamma*): brings misfortune, destroys wealth and enjoyment. Causes difficulties and problems in the course of one's life.
2. *Destructive, terminative karma* (*upacchedaka-kamma*): cuts off the life span prematurely, even if one is born through a karma tending to a long life-span. Simile: like a stone thrown up that knocks down an arrow in flight.
3. *Generative karma* (*janaka-kamma*): the karma that produces the mode of rebirth.
4. *Supportive karma* (*upatthambhaka-kamma*): karma that brings success in the course of life; removes obstacles and attracts good fortune.

(1) and (2) are necessarily unwholesome; (3) can be either wholesome or unwholesome; (4) is exclusively wholesome.

III. How contrasting modes of action determine rebirth and life-experiences

1. The destruction of life, killing
   a. In the role of "generative karma" it produces rebirth in the plane of misery (in hell).
   b. As "destructive karma," ripening in the human world, it can cut off another karma tending to a long life-span and bring premature death.
   c. As "oppressive karma" it impedes the efficacy of a generative karma tending to long life and thereby leads to short life-span.

   Note: According to Majjhima Commentary, it is the "determinative volition," i.e. the volition that actually "drives" the act of killing, that causes rebirth in a lower realm. The volitions preceding and following the act lead to short life in the human realm.

2. Abstaining from the destruction of life, non-killing
   a. In the role of "generative karma" produces rebirth in a heavenly world or a rebirth tending to long life in the human world.
   b. As "supportive karma," it reinforces another wholesome karma that has produced a human rebirth and removes obstructions and afflictions, thereby tending to long life in the human world.

   Note: According to Majjh. Comy., the determinative volition takes on role (a), the preceding and subsequent volitions take on role (b).

IV. The other pairs of contrasts

1. The paths to poor health and good health
    a. Injuring beings > lower rebirth or poor health in the human world
    b. Refraining from injury to beings > higher rebirth or good health in the human world
2. The paths to ugliness and beauty
    a. Persistently angry person > lower rebirth or ugliness in the human world
    b. Refraining from anger > higher rebirth or beauty in the human world
3. The paths to influence and lack of influence
    a. Envying others > lower rebirth or lack of influence in the human world
    b. Refraining from envy > higher rebirth or positions of influence in the human world
4. The paths to poverty and wealth
    a. Stinginess > lower rebirth or poverty in the human world
    b. Generosity > higher rebirth or wealth in the human world
5. The paths to low status and high status
    a. Arrogance > lower rebirth or low status in the human world
    b. Respect and reverence > higher rebirth or high status in the human world
6. The paths to dullness and wisdom
    a. Obtuseness > lower rebirth or dullness in the human world
    b. Investigation > higher rebirth or wisdom in the human world